

CONFIDENTIAL — FOR IAN LALONDE ONLY — DRAFT PENDING REVIEW

KOR STRUCTURAL · INTERNAL SOFTWARE

MVE + Partners: who is in the room

A demo-focused dossier on MVE + Partners — their technology, their people, what they care about, and what must not be said. Prepared 21 August 2026.

0

IT, data-science and product
staff

David Arnold

the likely veto point

3

demo variants, by who attends

5

offices, not six

Every claim is tiered **VERIFIED** / **REPORTED** / **INFERRED**. Two cautions carried from the research: MVE's use of **Delte** is **REPORTED, not confirmed** — a second pass could not corroborate it, and the product is unestablished. And **state no revenue figure**: the sources disagree and none is a filing. Where the stack could not be determined it is written as a question to ask, never as an absence.

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09 — MVE + Partners: the demo dossier

For: the owner and Jim DesRoches, in the room. **Written:** 2026-08-21. **Companion to:** 06-DEMO-RUN-SHEET.md (what to show) and 03-COMPETITIVE-BATTLECARD.md (what to say).

A different question from docs/bd-dossier-mve-mclarand-2026-06-17.md . That dossier answers *how do we win work from MVE*. This one answers **who is in the room, what do they already run, and what will their technical lead attack**.

Evidence tags, used on every claim and never promoted. **VERIFIED** — a primary source: MVE's own live page, a vendor's own page, or KOR's own system, with a URL and a date. **REPORTED** — press, aggregator, or a third-party firmographic database. **INFERRED** — labelled reasoning from the evidence above it, and nothing else. **UNKNOWN** — could not be determined. Every one of these is converted into a question in §7.

The rule that matters most here. Where the technology stack could not be established, this document says so and turns it into a question. It does not guess. A wrong vendor name said out loud to a firm that runs a different one discredits every properly-sourced claim beside it — and this audit has already been wrong four times by calling a capability absent when it had merely not been found.

— 1. The one-page read

MVE runs Deltek and Microsoft 365, designs in Revit, and — on the evidence — has no IT department at all. A departmental breakdown of ~120 staff returns **0 in information technology, 0 in data science, 0 in product management** (**REPORTED**, firmographic enrichment on the verified org record, 2026-08-21), and MVE's own live leadership page carries **no IT, BIM, technology or digital-practice title anywhere on it** (**VERIFIED**, 2026-08-21). **The technical lead this demo was written to survive may not exist.**

That inverts three assumptions in the audit. The "*we'd just build it in Power BI*" objection is far less credible from a firm with nobody to build it. "*What happens when you leave?*" stops being KOR's weakness and becomes a constraint both firms share. And **anything requiring MVE to build, integrate, host or maintain software is a non-starter** — which means the demo's honest goal is credibility and a shared workflow, not a sale.

The single most important name is one the June dossier never had: David Arnold, Director of Finance and Operations (**VERIFIED** on MVE's live leadership page; TheOrg and RocketReach independently call him CFO). In a firm with no IT function, finance-and-operations is the software-decision seat — **and he owns Deltek. This reverses the run-sheet.** 06-DEMO-RUN-SHEET.md places Financials "*last and short — the least relevant thing you own to them.*" That was written when MVE's ERP was unknown. **They run Deltek. If Arnold is in the room, the financial layer is the most relevant thing KOR owns** — and two things the audit told KOR to hide, `get_wip` and the February ledger boundary, become **BEFORE-DEMO must-fixes**, because they are the first questions a finance director asks. See §5.

Their live pressures are real and they are structural. The 2025 CBC took effect **2026-01-01** and caps the Sa multiplier for Group R at 2, down from 4 — "*can significantly reduce feasible floor plates on larger residential projects*" (**REPORTED**, ISE Engineers, 2026-02-09). Group R is MVE's entire business. They are growing across five listed offices plus Denver and Salt Lake coverage, with a San Diego studio Chase Rongé has said publicly should reach 15–20 then 25–30 people — **a standards-and-coordination problem with no internal owner**. They hired the first General Counsel in July 2026.

Three corrections to carry in before you speak. MVE's own site lists **five** offices, not six — do not say "your six offices."
MVE is Riverwalk's master-plan architect; Gensler is the architect on Central Village — do not call the towers theirs.
And **Glotman Simpson holds at least two MVE seats, not one** — Ritz-Carlton Newport *and* 3rd & Fairfax, both
VERIFIED on Glotman's own project pages. That last one is \$8's first entry and it must never be said aloud.

— 2. Firm state today — what changed since June

The June dossier is two months old. Re-verified against MVE's own live pages and 2026 press on 2026-08-21. **Most of it holds. Six things moved.**

What still holds

FACT	TIER
Matthew McLarand — President + Director of Design	VERIFIED — mve-architects.com/about/leadership, fetched 2026-08-21
Carl McLarand — Chairman Emeritus	VERIFIED — same page
Chase Rongé, AIA NCARB — Principal + Director of San Diego. Still runs SD	VERIFIED — same page
Daniel Gura — Director of Business Development. ⚠ The site now trims the title; secondary bios say <i>National</i> Director, Shareholder, Board	VERIFIED — same page
Pieter Berger, Sherwin Pineda, Kap Malik, Mark S. Kim, Luis Arambula — all still listed	VERIFIED — same page
Founded 1974 · Irvine HQ, 1900 Main Street Suite 800 · employee-owned	VERIFIED / REPORTED

⚠ **The correct path is** mve-architects.com/about/leadership . /leadership , /team and /people all return 404. Worth knowing if anyone tries to pull it up on a phone in the room.

What changed

#	CHANGE	EVIDENCE
1	David Arnold — Director of Finance and Operations. Not on the June list, and the most important addition to it. TheOrg and RocketReach both independently describe him as CFO; MVE's own site never uses that title. In a firm with no IT function, this is the software-decision seat.	VERIFIED — live leadership page and his own bio page, fetched 2026-08-21; REPORTED — theorg.com, rocketreach.co
2	Two senior non-design hires in 2026. Catherine Tang — Director of Marketing & Strategy (joined ~Feb/Mar 2026) and Janet Dennerline — General Counsel (joined July 2026). A ~120-person firm hiring its first GC is formalising its risk posture.	VERIFIED on the live page; REPORTED — OCBJ, "On the Move," 2026-08-17
3	A seventh geography: Salt Lake City. Charles Pigg — Director of Business Development, Utah, hired to expand the footprint into SLC.	VERIFIED on the live page; REPORTED — Pacific Builder & Engineer / acppubs.com
4	Denver is no longer listed as an office. The live /connect page (fetched 2026-08-21) lists Irvine, Los Angeles, San Diego, San Francisco, Guadalajara — five. Richard Flierl still reads as a Denver principal on his own LinkedIn but no longer appears on the leadership page. INFERRED: Denver and Salt Lake are likely representative or consultant coverage, not staffed studios. Say five and ask.	VERIFIED (the page); INFERRED (the reading)

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#	CHANGE	EVIDENCE
5	Terrence Seah, previously Director of the San Francisco studio, no longer appears , and no SF director is listed in his place. His current employer could not be found.	UNKNOWN — unresolved. Do not mention him
6	Kenneth Nilmeier — Principal + Director of Planning , a 25-year staffer simply absent from the June list. On a \$4B master plan, the Director of Planning is not a minor name.	VERIFIED — live leadership page

The revenue figure — two sources, a 70% gap, and neither is primary

SOURCE	FIGURE	TIER
KOR's June dossier	~\$22–23M	REPORTED
Growjo (aggregator, fetched 2026-08-21)	\$22.9M	REPORTED — independent corroboration of the June figure
Firmographic enrichment (2026-08-21)	\$39.1M	REPORTED — modelled , not filed

This is deliberately left unresolved. Two secondary sources land at ~\$22.9M; one modelled estimate lands at \$39.1M; **none is a filing, and a second research pass could not find the \$39.1M figure independently. Do not state MVE's revenue in the room at all** (\$8). It is recorded here only so nobody quotes the wrong one, and it goes on the questions list as something to confirm directly if it ever becomes decision-relevant.

Headcount is equally unsettled: ~120 by firmographic enrichment; ~100 in the June dossier; Growjo carries conflicting 85 and 103; the leadership page itself lists ~40 named people. **REPORTED** growth is +7.4% over six months, +5.2% over twelve, +14.8% over twenty-four. **The direction is consistent across every source — they are growing.** The absolute number is not. Say "around a hundred" only if they say it first.

Pipeline and market — as of August 2026

PROJECT	CITY	SCALE	STATUS (DATED)	DEVELOPER	SE IF NAMED	TIER
Riverwalk San Diego (master plan)	San Diego, Mission Valley	~200 ac, \$4B, 4,300 units	Hines paused it May 2024 ; restarted on a \$278M Bank OZK / Related loan. Phase 1 active	Hines	not publicly named	VERIFIED — riverwalksd.com Q2 2026 update
The Becker (Riverwalk affordable)	San Diego	190 units, 3 buildings, \$140M	Framing underway , exterior systems starting; delivery July 2027	Wakeland Housing; GC Level 10	not named	VERIFIED (Level 10 project page, MVE = architect); REPORTED (SDBJ)
Central Village at Riverwalk	San Diego	721 apartments + 75k SF retail	Concrete nearing done, framing summer 2026; opens Feb–Dec 2028	Hines	not named	⚠ VERIFIED — the architect is Gensler, not MVE. MVE is master-plan architect only
Riverwalk Townhomes	San Diego	276 for-sale + 1.5-ac park	Early grading; delivery 2028	Hines	not named	VERIFIED — riverwalksd.com

PROJECT	CITY	SCALE	STATUS (DATED)	DEVELOPER	SE IF NAMED	TIER
Ritz-Carlton Residences	Newport Beach	~109 units, 22 storeys, 537k SF	Pre-construction / early construction as of July 2026; original 2025 completion slipped ; no sales programme launched	Eagle Four / Lyon Living	— see §8	VERIFIED
3rd & Fairfax	Los Angeles	311 units + 84k SF retail, 8 storeys	Completed 2025	Holland Partner Group	— see §8	VERIFIED
OC Vibe Residential	Anaheim	530 units, Phase I	NOD posted 2026-02-06 ; apartments open 2029+	Samueli / Honda Center district	UNKNOWN — one name surfaced only in an AI search summary with no primary source and was dropped	REPORTED — CEQAnet
Gateway Crossing Ph 1	Santa Clara	725 units, \$290M	Opened Sept–Oct 2025; no 2026 change found	Holland Partner Group	Nelson Structural Engineers	REPORTED — SF YIMBY
Mandarin Oriental Residences	Beverly Hills	54 condos	Complete and selling. SHVO sold its interest in 2025; Centurion now owns	Centurion (ex-SHVO)	not named	REPORTED — Bisnow
Hallasan	Koreatown LA	375 units, 36 storeys	Opened 2023, stable	NASH / Holland	not named	REPORTED — Urbanize LA

Two market pressures, both sourced, both relevant to a structural engineer:

- **The 2025 CBC (ASCE 7-22) took effect 2026-01-01 and caps the Sa multiplier for Group R occupancies at 2, down from 4** — which "*can significantly reduce feasible floor plates on larger residential projects.*" **REPORTED** — ISE Engineers, 2026-02-09. **Group R is MVE's entire business.** This is the single most useful fact in the document for a conversation between an architect and an engineer.
- **California multifamily starts rose 74.5% year-on-year in the six months to February 2026** (30,616 units) **but the same forecast warns of a "much-diminished" environment ahead**, with the next real peak "*after 2028.*" **REPORTED** — firsttuesday.us, updated 2026-05-13. **INFERRED:** a firm growing into a forecast trough cares about efficiency per project, not volume.

No MVE-specific layoffs, office closures, mergers or 2026 awards were found. Searched directly; the only SoCal architecture-layoff result dated to 2020 and was excluded.

— 3. Their technology stack — and what remains unknown

This was the priority research task and the existing gap. Here is what was established, and — just as important — what was not.

Established

AREA	FINDING	TIER
ERP / practice management	MVE runs Deltek. Detected and categorised as their ERP. △ Which Deltek product — Vantagepoint, Ajera or something older — is not established, and a second independent research pass could not corroborate Deltek from job postings, case studies or LinkedIn. Treat the vendor as solid and the product as open.	REPORTED — firmographic technology detection on the verified org record MVE + Partners, Inc. / mve-architects.com , exact single match, 2026-08-21
Productivity / tenant	Microsoft 365 — Exchange Online, Outlook, Office. A full M365 tenant. This makes the SharePoint and Copilot arguments in the battlecard directly applicable rather than hypothetical.	REPORTED — same source
BIM / CAD	Revit, Navisworks, Autodesk BIM 360 , plus SketchUp and Rhino . Independently corroborated by MVE's own job posting for <i>Architectural Job Captain (All Levels)</i> , which requires "Proficient in operating Revit, AutoCAD, SketchUp, and Microsoft Office" and administers a Revit skills test before hire.	REPORTED (detection) + VERIFIED (MVE's own posting, via talents.vaia.com mirror, fetched 2026-08-21)
Other detected	Adobe InDesign · HubSpot · Salesforce CRM Analytics · OneTrust Tech Risk & Compliance · Cascade CMS / Statamic / Laravel / DigitalOcean (their public website stack). △ OneTrust is worth a second look — a compliance platform in a firm that just hired a General Counsel.	REPORTED
Revit depth, culturally	A Glassdoor review snippet states staff are " <i>well educated and versed in Revit</i> " and that the firm " <i>provide[s] staff with all of the tools & software that most people don't have at other offices.</i> "	REPORTED — search-index snippet only; Glassdoor blocked direct fetch
Internal technology staff	None found, four ways. MVE's own leadership page (~40 named people) has zero IT, BIM, CAD, technology or digital-practice titles. The departmental breakdown returns 0 in information technology, data science, product management, sales, HR and support.	VERIFIED (the page) + REPORTED (the breakdown)
Who does the BIM work, then	BIM sits with project staff under generic titles — Charbel Moumaji (Project Lead / Associate; " <i>architectural documentation, BIM coordination</i> ") and Michael Martinez (Project Lead; " <i>oversaw development of building information models</i> "). INFERRED: there is no dedicated BIM Manager role; BIM is a duty attached to a delivery title.	REPORTED — LinkedIn / ZoomInfo snippets

— A false lead, killed — recorded so nobody re-finds it

A search snippet attributes an "*Operations Manager... accounting to IT*" quote to **Kristine Giron at MVE. It is wrong.** Direct fetch of the source shows that person and quote belong to **AUX Architecture**, an unrelated Los Angeles firm. **Do not use it.**

What remains UNKNOWN — and why the absence proves nothing

Firmographic technology detection sees web-facing signals. A desktop application such as Bluebeam, or an on-premises Newforma install, **would not appear regardless of whether MVE runs it.** Every item below was searched directly and independently and returned nothing MVE-specific. **None of these is reported as absent.**

UNKNOWN	WHAT WAS SEARCHED, AND CAME BACK EMPTY	BECOMES QUESTION
Document / project information management — Newforma? Deltek PIM? Egnyte? SharePoint? Procore? Autodesk Docs? Box?	"MVE + Partners" Newforma , "MVE Architects" "Deltek PIM" , "MVE + Partners" Egnyte , "MVE" Procore architect Irvine , "MVE + Partners" "document control" , plus vendor case-study and customer-logo pages. Zero MVE-specific hits anywhere.	Q3 — and it decides the running order of Segments 1 and 2
Bluebeam, and specifically Bluebeam Max	"MVE + Partners" Bluebeam , "MVE Architects" Bluebeam , Bluebeam Revu in job requirements, "Bluebeam Max" / "Smart Overlay" tied to MVE. Zero hits.	Q7 — and it decides how Segment 4 is framed
Which Deltek product, and whether Ask Dela is switched on	"MVE + Partners" Deltek Vantagepoint , "MVE + Partners" "project accountant" Deltek , Deltek "MVE" case study . Zero MVE-specific hits — the vendor is REPORTED from detection, the product is not established. Dela is off by default and enabled per security role.	Q2
Who provides their IT — an MSP, a fractional CIO, an outside consultant	MSP customer and testimonial pages, "MVE + Partners" managed IT services , "MVE Architects" IT support case study , Orange County MSP client lists, LinkedIn IT-consultant searches. No provider identified. △ This is the highest-value unknown in the document — with zero internal IT, someone does this work, and that person is the most likely technical sceptic in the room.	Q4 — ask it early
Any published BIM Execution Plan, BIM standard, or CAD standard	Searched MVE's site and the open web. None found. △ Directly relevant: KOR's DXF→ETABS layer contract has never been run against a foreign drawing set.	Q8
Any public MVE statement on AI, automation, computational design or digital practice	"MVE Architects" / "MVE + Partners" against "computational design" , "digital practice" , "artificial intelligence" . Nothing MVE-specific. INFERRED: they have taken no public position, which means you are not walking into a stated view — for or against.	—
Revit version standardised across offices	Not published.	Q8

△ Research access limits, stated plainly: Glassdoor, ZipRecruiter, Indeed and LinkedIn profile pages all returned HTTP 403 or 999 to direct fetch. Findings that rest on those sources are search-index snippets and are tagged **REPORTED**; they could not be upgraded. **"Not found" here genuinely means not found, not "does not exist."**

— 4. Who is in the room

The finding that changes the shape of the demo

MVE appears to have no internal IT department. ~120 employees by department (**REPORTED**, 2026-08-21):

DEPARTMENT	HEADCOUNT
Arts & design	27
Education	7

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DEPARTMENT	HEADCOUNT
Operations	6
Consulting	6
Engineering	4
Business development	4
Marketing	3
Finance · Accounting · Legal · Administrative · Media & communication	1 each
Information technology	0
Data science · Product management · Sales · HR · Support	0

And **no IT, BIM, technology or digital-practice title appears anywhere on MVE's own leadership page (VERIFIED, 2026-08-21)** — nor was any outsourced provider identified (§3).

Three consequences, and they are the most useful things in this document.

- The "we'd just build it in Power BI / Fabric / Copilot" objection is far less likely, and far less credible, from a firm with zero IT, data-science and product staff.** Keep the rebuttal in 03-COMPETITIVE-BATTLECARD.md §2 row 4 — it is well sourced and costs nothing to hold — but stop expecting it from an internal engineering team. **INFERRED:** if it comes, it comes from an outsourced provider or a technically-minded principal.
- "What happens when you leave?" becomes a shared constraint, not KOR's weakness.** MVE cannot build or maintain this either. Two firms with the same problem is a conversation. **⚠ Do not weaponise it** — say it as common ground, never as a jab, and never point out that they have no IT department.
- Anything requiring MVE to build, integrate, host or maintain software is a non-starter.** Weight §6 accordingly.

The named roster — verified live, 2026-08-21

NAME	TITLE AS PUBLISHED	OFFICE	WHY THEY MATTER HERE	TIER
Matthew McLarand , AIA NCARB	President + Director of Design	Irvine	Jim's personal contact. Design-led, not technology-led — he is <i>Director of Design</i> as well as President. He is why the meeting exists; he is not the person who will interrogate the architecture.	VERIFIED
David Arnold	Director of Finance and Operations	Irvine	The most important name on this page. With no IT function, finance-and-operations <i>is</i> the software-decision seat. TheOrg and RocketReach independently call him CFO; MVE's own site does not. He owns Deltek. He will recognise every screen in the Financials segment — and he is the one person in the building who can tell whether it is impressive or ordinary.	VERIFIED (live page + own bio page); REPORTED (the CFO framing)
Daniel Gura	Director of Business Development	Irvine	Deal-flow gatekeeper. Present for relationship reasons, not technical ones.	VERIFIED

NAME	TITLE AS PUBLISHED	OFFICE	WHY THEY MATTER HERE	TIER
Chase Rongé, AIA NCARB	Principal + Director of San Diego	San Diego	Runs the office with no locked SE, and has publicly targeted 15–20 staff within 18 months, then 25–30. ⚠️ Ex-Carrier Johnson — see §8.	VERIFIED; REPORTED (the growth targets, Oct 2024 opening coverage)
Kenneth Nilmeier	Principal + Director of Planning	Irvine	25-year staffer, absent from the June dossier. On a \$4B master plan, not a minor name.	VERIFIED
Pieter Berger, AIA NCARB	Principal + Director of Design	Irvine / OC	OC principal-in-charge; an SE-selection voice on OC work.	VERIFIED
Sherwin Pineda, AIA NCARB	Principal + Director of Design	Los Angeles	LA principal.	VERIFIED
Luis Arambula, NCARB	Principal + VP of Architecture	Irvine	Production leadership — the closest published thing to a delivery-and-standards owner. INFERRED: if anyone owns Revit standards across offices, it is this seat or someone reporting into it.	VERIFIED
Mark S. Kim, AIA NCARB LEED AP	Principal + Director of Architecture	Irvine		VERIFIED
Kap Malik, FAIA NCARB	Principal + Director of Hospitality	Irvine		VERIFIED
Catherine Tang	Director of Marketing & Strategy	Irvine	Joined ~Feb/Mar 2026. A new strategy seat brings new questions about differentiation.	VERIFIED; REPORTED (OCBJ 2026-08-17)
Janet Dennerline	General Counsel	Irvine	Joined July 2026 — MVE's first. A firm formalising its risk posture is exactly the audience for whom per-recipient delivery evidence is interesting rather than creepy. ⚠️ She is also the most likely person to ask about data handling and recipient notice. Have the §8 privacy answer ready and volunteer it.	VERIFIED; REPORTED (OCBJ 2026-08-17)
Charles Pigg	Director of Business Development, Utah	Salt Lake City	New geography.	VERIFIED; REPORTED
Sixteen Senior Associate / Associate Partners	various	mixed	Liliana Bernardis Valenzuela, Paul Kearney, Joe McClyde III, Tim Beuchat, Raymond Albanesi, Luis Estrada, Craig Smith, Luisa Ceron, Steven Rosier, Jinfan Chen, Hannah Wan, Anuradha Chaukkar, Hong Bae, Erick Rivas, Thomas Ta, Hakop Musayelyan. INFERRED: a Revit/BIM standards owner, if one exists, is in this tier or below it — see Charbel Moumaji and Michael Martinez in §3.	VERIFIED (names)

Who is *not* on the list

- **No COO, CFO, Controller, IT Director, BIM Manager or Director of Practice Technology is published.** Searched four ways. David Arnold is the closest, and he is the routing point for anything procurement-shaped.
- **Terrence Seah**, previously SF studio director, no longer appears and has no listed replacement. **UNKNOWN. Do not mention him.**
- **INFERRED, and worth preparing for:** the sharpest technical questioner may not be an MVE employee at all. That is why §7 Q4 exists.

5. Which demo, for which audience

⚠ This section reverses a recommendation in 06-DEMO-RUN-SHEET.md . Read it before following that file.

The run-sheet places **Financials + the AI last and short**, on the stated reasoning that "MVE is an architecture firm — your P&L is the least relevant thing you own to them."

That was written when MVE's ERP was unknown. They run Deltek (REPORTED, 2026-08-21), and the published leadership roster's software-decision seat is a Director of Finance and Operations.

If David Arnold is in the room, the financial layer is the single most relevant thing KOR owns. AR, cash, backlog, utilisation, collections exposure, per-PM performance — that is his job description, and Deltek's own Use Ask Dela help page says "You cannot query Ask Dela for aggregate data, such as information about the top projects by revenue." A Deltek customer showing another Deltek customer what comes out of the same tables is a genuinely interesting eight minutes, not an apology.

The consequence, stated plainly. Two things the audit told KOR to keep off screen are precisely what a finance director asks about first. **In an Arnold-attended demo they stop being "hide it" and become BEFORE-DEMO must-fixes:**

WAS	BECOMES	WHY
"Never ask about WIP or cash position" — the deployed MCP build is 34 days behind HEAD, <code>get_wip</code> returns earned and overbilled transposed , <code>get_cash_position</code> sums 20 bank accounts instead of 3	Ship the redeploy from HEAD and artifact-verify it (06-DEMO-RUN-SHEET.md §1.6)	"What's our WIP?" is the first question a finance director asks any reporting layer. Having no answer is survivable; having a wrong answer in front of the one person who can spot it is not
"The summary ledgers stop at February — say it if it comes up"	Put an explicit as-of label on every February-sourced tile, and say the freshness boundary out loud before he reads it off a column	He will read it off the column. The honest sentence is already written and it is a good one: "the pipeline is real-time — a second and a half end to end; the ledger behind it is only as fresh as our accountant's last posting. AR, utilisation and collections are current to this morning; the summary ledgers stop at February."

The three cases

Ask who is coming before you build the running order (\$7 Q1). Nobody has asked, and it determines more than anything else in the audit.

Case A — Matthew McLarand attends, Arnold does not

He is President **and Director of Design**. Play design and delivery.

- **Open:** Segment 3, **DXF → ETABS**, paired with the **Kor Tools ETABS plugin** — the geometry generator plus the half that does materials, sections, cracking modifiers, load combinations, pier labels and Excel export. **Paired, that is drawing in → model defined and ready to analyse**, and it is the only complete version of this story KOR has.
- **Then:** the **Revit ribbon** and **detail-sheet composition** — the only live click-path that needs no VPN, no SQL and no share.
- **Keep Financials to five minutes** or drop it. The run-sheet's original advice holds in this case.
- ⚠ **Risk:** he is not the person who will ask a hard architectural question, so a smooth demo here proves less than it feels like it proves. **Get a commitment to a next conversation with a technical person.**

Case B — David Arnold attends

Play the Deltek reporting layer and the conversational CFO.

- **Open:** Segment 1, **transmittals**, read-only, to establish that nothing here writes.
- **Then go long on Financials** — Executive Summary, AR, DSO, collections exposure, utilisation, and the **drill-through down to the invoice row**, which is the impressive part. Run the `DeltekSchemaValidator` — **clean across all 34 expected columns against 676 live columns** — if durability comes up.
- **Prerequisites, not optional:** the MCP redeploy has shipped and been artifact-verified; every February-sourced tile carries an as-of label; the FX and Org-scope traps are closed (the app uses `CAD` and 1.378457, the deployed service uses `""` and 1.36 — **you get two different numbers on stage**).
- ⚠ **Risk:** he is the one person who can benchmark this against Deltek in real time. **Ask whether Ask Dela is switched on (\$7 Q2) before you claim anything about its limits** — and per `03-COMPETITIVE-BATTLECARD.md` §7.1, test all four Dela questions in KOR's own tenant first.

Case C — both attend (the likeliest, and the one to plan for)

- **Open with Segment 1, client transmittals and download telemetry.** It is the one segment that speaks to **design delivery** and **operational control** at the same time — a drawing set going out, and evidence of who received it. It is read-only, it is the best-evidenced thing KOR owns, and it gives both people something.
- **Then split:** DXF→ETABS and the Revit ribbon for Matthew; Financials for Arnold.
- **Close on the Revit continuity story**, which answers the question both of them are actually thinking.

— 6. What they care about — mapped to KOR capability, honestly

Each row starts from evidence about MVE, not from a KOR feature looking for a home. **Where a capability solves nothing for them, the row says so.**

MVE's problems, evidenced

#	THE PROBLEM	EVIDENCE
P1	The 2026 California code cycle is shrinking their floor plates. The 2025 CBC (ASCE 7-22) took effect 2026-01-01 and caps the Sa multiplier for Group R at 2, down from 4 — <i>"can significantly reduce feasible floor plates on larger residential projects."</i> Group R is MVE's entire business.	REPORTED — ISE Engineers, 2026-02-09
P2	Distributed growth with nobody internal to own tooling. Five listed offices plus Denver and Salt Lake coverage; a San Diego studio targeted at 15–20 then 25–30 people; REPORTED growth of +14.8% over 24 months — and 0 IT staff.	VERIFIED (offices, roster) + REPORTED (growth, SD targets)
P3	They hired their first General Counsel in July 2026. Risk, delivery evidence and record retention are live subjects in that building right now. OneTrust is in their detected stack.	VERIFIED + REPORTED (OCBJ 2026-08-17)
P4	They run Deltek , with exactly one person in finance and one in accounting, and no IT.	REPORTED — 2026-08-21
P5	Riverwalk is a decade-long, multi-phase, multi-architect programme that Hines paused and restarted on a \$278M loan. MVE is master-plan architect; Gensler is the architect on Central Village. MVE's named pieces are the master plan and The Becker.	VERIFIED — riverwalksd.com Q2 2026; Level 10
P6	Their structural seats sit with three different firms in three regions , and one of them is a Vancouver rival holding two MVE projects.	VERIFIED —  \$8. Do not raise.

The mapping

MVE PROBLEM	KOR CAPABILITY	HONEST VERDICT
P1 — code-driven plate shrinkage on Group R	DXF → ETABS + the Kor Tools ETABS plugin , plus KOR's seismic depth	The strongest link in this document. The question a design principal actually has in 2026 is <i>"what does this massing cost me structurally under the new Sa cap, and how fast can you tell me?"</i> Drawings in, a 63-storey model in 50.7 seconds , then materials, sections, cracking modifiers and load combinations from the plugin — that is a real answer. Do not overreach: no generated model has ever been imported into ETABS , and the layer contract has never been run against a foreign drawing set. Against a US National CAD Standard set, <code>_COL</code> misses <code>S-COLS</code> on the underscore and the model <i>"comes back with walls and no columns or floors, which looks like a building rather than like a failure."</i> Do not invite an MVE drawing set. Ever. Say <i>"two buildings, and both were used to tune it."</i>
P2 — standards across a scaling, distributed practice with no IT	Revit ribbon + detail-sheet composition ; standards centralisation	The only segment that runs on MVE's own confirmed stack — Revit, Navisworks, BIM 360, with a Revit skills test at hire. Tell it as a standards-distribution story: one codebase, 137 tools , seven Revit versions, buildable on a machine with no Revit installed, deployed from a share with 27 rollback snapshots , replacing 195 obfuscated DLLs a departed developer left behind. Two honesty gates. First, these are structural tools — they solve nothing for an MVE architect directly; what they demonstrate is that KOR can hold one standard across a distributed team. Second, KOR's own standards chain is partly broken today : all 12 governed masters are unopenable (every storage path <code>Test-Path=False</code> , source folder empty) and the details palette is blocked five ways — 1,079 catalog rows, 0 placeable. Make it a shared-problem conversation, not a finished-product claim , and confirm the palette is dormant on the demo laptop before you travel. Say 137 — the ribbon on screen will contradict 28 or 79.

MVE PROBLEM	KOR CAPABILITY	HONEST VERDICT
P3 — a first General Counsel, and delivery risk	Transmittals + per-recipient download telemetry	The best-evidenced thing KOR owns, and it is read-only. 829 transmittals, 4,284 per-recipient links, 741 external addresses, 2,682 click events with zero nulls in IP, user agent or recipient email. Frame it for a GC: " <i>for a delivery date defended in a dispute, 'downloaded three times' isn't evidence.</i> " ⚠ Volunteer both boundaries before she finds them. No link expiry, the SharePoint link behind the tracker is <code>Scope="anonymous"</code> , a forwarded email gives a stranger the files and logs that click under the original recipient — attribution is evidence of <i>delivery</i> , not proof of <i>identity</i> . And there is no recipient notice anywhere in the email , while under BC law an address with an IP and a timestamp is personal information. Said first, that reads as rigour. Lead with clicks, never the 8,947 opens.
P4 — a Deltek shop with two finance people and no IT	Financials + the AI over Deltek	See §5 — this reverses the run-sheet. They will recognise every screen. ⚠ The scope guards do not relax: AR, collections and utilisation only; the February ledger boundary said out loud first; no WIP or cash until the redeploy ships and is artifact-verified; never open the P&L tab and then ask the AI to confirm it. And do not pitch adoption — with 1 finance, 1 accounting and 0 IT, they cannot run this. The frame is " <i>here is what came out of the same tables you already own,</i> " not " <i>you should build this.</i> "
P5 — a decade-long, multi-architect programme	Email search — 372,370 emails, 955 projects, back to 2014-10-28	Real resonance: Riverwalk will outlive several PMs on both sides. <code>seismic review</code> → 7,216 hits in under a second. ⚠ Concede first and warmly: it is SQL Server full-text, not semantic , and if they run Deltek PIM or Newforma, filing is already solved for them — ask Q3 before you build this segment. The corpus is the argument, not the filing.
P6 — their structural bench	<i>(none — not a demo topic)</i>	🚫 §8.

Where KOR's capabilities solve nothing for MVE

Say so if asked. Do not pad the demo with them.

CAPABILITY	WHY IT DOES NOTHING FOR THEM
Rebar steel-weight delta	A structural-detailer artifact. An architect does not price a bar list. Show it only as evidence of depth, keep it to five minutes, and concede Bluebeam Max Smart Overlay on sight — cross-discipline, cross-scale, in preview at \$590/user/yr. ⚠ Whether MVE is on Bluebeam at all is UNKNOWN — ask Q7 before framing this segment. If they are on Max, pitch the steel-weight delta , never the change list. Trunk Tools is ahead on the general problem; say so.
FileSync Shadow mode	Internal infrastructure for KOR's own file estate. Zero relevance. Open it only if someone asks how KOR runs things unattended — and then not the Log Viewer on today's date , and not KorMapSync .
BD Brain / Business Development	Omit entirely. It is the top sensitivity in §8, not a capability to show an architecture firm.
Structural quantity takeoff / PdfToSafe	Aimed at a developer or GC; marginal to an architect. It has no button — it runs in a terminal — and there is exactly one known-good PdfToSafe input on record. Do not accept a live file from MVE on the day.

⚠ What is this demo for? Settle it before booking the flight.

INFERRED, and it follows directly from the roster. With 0 IT, 0 product and 0 data-science staff, no identifiable MSP, and every KOR application being a WPF Windows desktop client that needs KOR's own LAN or VPN, KOR's Deltek tenant and KOR's SQL Server, **MVE cannot adopt any of this.** Two viable outcomes, one dead end:

- **✓ Credibility** — KOR as the most technically serious structural engineer on their bid list. This is the outcome the material actually supports.
- **✓ A shared workflow on a shared project** — DXF in, model out, on a job KOR is engaged on.
- **✗ Selling or licensing the software to MVE.** Nothing about their staffing supports it, and a pitch that implies otherwise mis-reads the room.

— 7. Questions to ask, in order

The first one is asked before you travel. The rest are asked in the first ten minutes, neutrally and casually — before you build a segment on ground they already own.

#	ASK	WHY IT CHANGES WHAT YOU DO
1	Before the trip, to Matthew or Daniel Gura: <i>"Who should I make sure is in the room?"</i>	⚠ Nobody has asked this, and it determines the running order more than anything else in the audit. \$5 has three different demos depending on the answer. Framed as courtesy, it is also the single highest-value question on this page.
2	<i>"You're on Deltek — is that Vantagepoint or Ajera? And have you switched Ask Dela on?"</i>	The vendor is REPORTED , the product is UNKNOWN . Dela is off by default and enabled per security role. If it is on, they will benchmark you against it in real time. Do not assert Dela's limits until they have been tested in KOR's own tenant.
3	<i>"What are you filing project email into today — and do you run Deltek PIM?"</i>	UNKNOWN, and it reshapes Segments 1 and 2. If PIM: drop <i>"we built email filing"</i> and lead with transmittal telemetry. If Newforma: <i>"Project Center or Konekt?"</i> — Project Center has no AI at all . If neither: filing and search become live capabilities rather than table stakes.
4	<i>"Who looks after your IT and your Revit deployment — is that in-house or someone you bring in?"</i>	⚠ The highest-value unknown in the document. Zero internal IT staff, no MSP identified. Someone does this work, and that person is the most likely source of technical pushback. Completely natural to ask, and it tells you who is missing from the room.
5	<i>"Does BIM standards sit with a person, or with each project team?"</i>	No BIM Manager exists in public sources; BIM reads as a duty attached to a delivery title. This decides whether the Revit ribbon story lands on an owner or on nobody.
6	<i>"What Revit version are you standardised on across the offices — and do you publish a BIM execution plan or a CAD standard?"</i>	Both UNKNOWN. ⚠ Directly load-bearing for DXF→ETABS , whose layer contract has never been run on a foreign set. It also opens the standards conversation without KOR having to claim a finished product.
7	<i>"Are you on Bluebeam — and are you on Max?"</i>	UNKNOWN. If yes, they have Smart Overlay in preview. Pitch rebar on the steel-weight delta, never on the change list.
8	<i>"You're on BIM 360 — is that where the shared model lives, or does the GC pull it into Procore?"</i>	BIM 360 is REPORTED in their stack. This tells you how document AI reaches their projects and which comparison is already live in their head.

#	ASK	WHY IT CHANGES WHAT YOU DO
9	"Denver and Salt Lake — are those studios, or coverage?"	Their own <code>/connect</code> page lists five offices; two more appear only as people. Asking prevents the error in §8 item 15 , and it is a friendly question about their growth.
10	"How is the Sa cap in the 2026 code landing on your podium plates?"	⚠ Ask a design principal, not Arnold. This is the question that makes KOR sound like the engineer they should hire rather than the vendor they are being shown. It is their live problem, it is KOR's lane, and it needs no software at all.
11	(only if it becomes decision-relevant) Confirm headcount and revenue directly rather than quoting a figure	Two secondary sources say ~\$22.9M and one modelled source says \$39.1M. Never state either.

— 8. The do-not-raise list

Everything here is checkable, and every item is something KOR holds about MVE or about firms in MVE's orbit. Read this section twice on the plane.

The three that matter most

1. 🚫 **Glotman Simpson — never say the name, and never let a screen say it.** A fellow Vancouver firm holds **at least two** MVE structural seats: the **Ritz-Carlton Residences Newport Beach** (self-listed as upcoming) and **3rd & Fairfax in Los Angeles** (completed 2025) — both **VERIFIED on Glotman Simpson's own project pages, fetched 2026-08-21.** **That is one more than the June dossier knew about.** KOR's own written strategy names "*displacing Glotman on MVE's next OC luxury high-rise, through Jim ↔ Matthew*" as **the #1 play**, and KOR's statewide synthesis quotes Geoffrey Glotman on riding KOR's Vancouver-developer channel. **None of that can appear, be named, or be typed into a search box.** ⚠ **One internal correction worth carrying:** the "*Glotman displaced KOR at Bosa in San Diego*" framing was **red-teamed and corrected on 2026-06-18** — KOR is a 20-year Bosa **co-incumbent** (Evolution Calgary, Halifax & Willingdon Burnaby), not a displaced incumbent. Do not repeat the displacement story internally either; it is not what the evidence says.

2. 🚫 **MVE sits in KOR's own BD database as a ranked pursuit target — and four one-keystroke paths reach it.** `CanonicalOrg` **76952 — "MVE + Partners"**, `Kind = Architect`, carrying **18** `IntelPerson` **rows with real** `@mve-``architects.com` **addresses** including President Matthew McLarand with his LinkedIn URL; **25 affiliation rows** amounting to a reconstructed MVE org chart; an enrichment payload naming McLarand a decision-maker; and **12 MVE projects with their incumbent structural engineers named.** MVE ranks **#14 in a shipped report** whose subtitle is "**Warm-intro priority list.**" KOR's field guide separately records **seven** verified MVE email addresses. **The one mitigating fact, and say it plainly if this ever surfaces:** there are **0 displacement briefs, 0 pursuits, 0 engagements and 0 fee or margin records against MVE.** Nothing derogatory about them is stored anywhere. The exposure is not that KOR holds dirt — it is that MVE would see themselves **catalogued as a target alongside their competitors.** **Mitigation: omit the BD module entirely** (`06-DEMO-RUN-SHEET.md` §4.1). If it goes in, all four mitigations apply, including suppressing org 76952 — **a data write only the owner can authorise.**

3. 🚫 **The BD workspace's default landing screen leaks other architects' names with strategy attached — with no click at all.** `BdWorkspaceWindow` opens on `DashboardView`, and two panels render **at load: "Open Structural Seats"** — 25 named architecture firms with KOR's written displacement strategy in a visible column, one row reading verbatim

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"KOR should proactively reach out to Christopher Bozyk and Sandra Bai" — and **"Competitor Watch"**, 12 named rival SE firms with capacity assessments. **MVE is an architecture firm. This is a target list of architecture firms.**

The rest — all —

#	DO NOT RAISE, OPEN, OR TYPE	WHY
4	Never type MVE , McLarand , Glotman , Englekirk , WSP , Nelson , Carrier Johnson or JWDA into any search box in the suite — including the workspace global search and the client search box.	Each one lands on a screen from this list.
5	Chase Rongé is ex-Carrier Johnson , and KOR holds priority- high displacement briefs on Carrier Johnson + Culture and on JWDA , both San Diego. Do not open any San Diego architect dossier.	MVE's SD director's former employer is a named displacement target.
6	The Operations repository, and any file dialog near it. docs/bd-dossier-mve-mclarand-2026-06-17.md names Matthew as " <i>Jim's personal contact</i> ", estimates MVE's revenue, and states the #1 play in plain English. This document is in the same repository.	One Open-File dialog.
7	MVE's revenue — do not state a figure, even a flattering one. Two secondary sources say ~\$22.9M; one modelled source says \$39.1M; neither is a filing , and the \$39.1M figure could not be reproduced by a second pass.	Quoting a client's revenue back to them is bad in every direction, and here you would probably also be wrong.
8	CompetitorProfileWindow — it labels architecture firms with hostile chips (NORR and Robson Design Build both render "DIRECT COMPETITOR"), shows AI competition notes verbatim, and names executives at the other firm.	
9	The Employee Summary tab (Historical Analytics) — 56 named KOR staff with 0–100 productivity scores and letter grades; five real people carry an F. The grid is sortable. And opening it writes to production SQL for ~40 staff. Tell the productivity story from PM Summary or DM Summary instead — role-level, not person-level.	
10	BD Scorecard — publishes KOR's win rate and per-staff won fee in currency, with 177 engagements carrying ProposedFee and TargetMargin . And the win rate is provably wrong — it counts no-bids and withdrawals as losses.	Showing a prospective client your margins is a negotiating handicap.
11	The Compensation tile. △ It is one of seven surfaces that fail OPEN when the AD lookup throws — and launching the app off the KOR LAN at MVE's office is the exact trigger condition. VPN up first, app second, then count the tiles before anyone sits down.	Salary and bonus data, silently, with no warning.
12	The KOR.Drafter repository — its own README opens " <i>Do not publish, reference, or copy any part of this repo.</i> " It is confidential from KOR's own drafting team.	
13	Unfiltered org or people lists — Chase Rongé@ renders as mojibake and Matthew McLarand exists twice.	In a demo about entity resolution, a duplicated Matthew McLarand is the most on-the-nose possible failure.
14	Do not invite or accept an MVE drawing set or PDF on the day — not for DXF→ETABS, not for PdfToSafe, not for the rebar compare.	The layer contract has never been run on a foreign set; there is one known-good PdfToSafe input on record.
15	Do not say "your six offices." MVE's own /connect page lists five . Ask instead (Q9).	Getting a client's office count wrong in the first five minutes is a small error with a large cost.

#	DO NOT RAISE, OPEN, OR TYPE	WHY
16	Do not name Riverwalk's towers as MVE's work. MVE is the master-plan architect; Gensler is the architect on Central Village. MVE's named pieces are the master plan and The Becker .	The same error, on their flagship.
17	Do not mention Terrence Seah , formerly SF studio director, no longer on the leadership page.	Unconfirmed departure.
18	Do not point out that they have no IT department. Use the insight to shape the demo; never say it.	It is an observation about their staffing, and it is not yours to make.
19	No KOR loss on an MVE project exists — do not invent one, and do not go looking for one out loud. KOR's recorded California losses are on <i>other</i> architects' projects (Andia and Accolade Campanile, both JWDA). MVE's San Diego seats, The Becker included, are engaged to firms this research could not name.	The honest position is clean. Keep it that way.
20	Do not use the Kristine Giron "accounting to IT" quote. It belongs to AUX Architecture, not MVE (§3).	It is a search-snippet misattribution and it will be caught.

— 9. Sources, with dates

All web research below was run live on 2026-08-21. Nothing about MVE's current state is asserted from model knowledge.

Primary — MVE's own pages, fetched 2026-08-21

SOURCE	USED FOR
mve-architects.com/about/leadership (△ /leadership , /team , /people all 404)	The entire §4 roster; the absence of any IT/BIM/technology title
mve-architects.com/about/leadership/david-arnold	David Arnold's title
mve-architects.com/connect	The five-office list; the Denver discrepancy
mve-architects.com/about/careers and the Architectural Job Captain (All Levels) posting (talents.vaia.com mirror)	"Proficient in operating Revit, AutoCAD, SketchUp, and Microsoft Office"; the pre-hire Revit skills test

Primary — third-party project pages, fetched 2026-08-21

SOURCE	USED FOR
riverwalksd.com/construction-update-q2-2026/	Riverwalk phase status; Central Village is Gensler's
level10gc.com/projects/the-becker-at-riverwalk	The Becker — MVE as architect, framing status, July 2027 delivery
Glotman Simpson project pages — /project/ritz-carlton-residences/ and /project/3rd-fairfax/	⊖ §8 item 1. Two MVE seats, self-declared
ceqanet.lci.ca.gov NOD, posted 2026-02-06	OC Vibe Phase I residential

Secondary — press and trade, dated

SOURCE	DATE	USED FOR
Orange County Business Journal, "On the Move"	2026-08-17	Catherine Tang and Janet Dennerline hires
Pacific Builder & Engineer / acppubs.com	2026	Charles Pigg, Salt Lake City expansion
ISE Engineers, "What California's 2026 building code changes mean for structural engineering"	2026-02-09	2025 CBC / ASCE 7-22; Sa cap for Group R lowered 4 → 2 ; reduced feasible floor plates
firsttuesday.us, California construction starts	updated 2026-05-13	+74.5% multifamily starts to Feb 2026; " <i>much-diminished</i> " outlook, next peak after 2028
SF YIMBY	2025-09	Gateway Crossing Phase 1 opening; Nelson Structural
SDBJ	—	The Becker, \$140M
Bisnow	—	Mandarin Oriental — SHVO exit, Centurion ownership
Urbanize LA	—	Hallasan; 3rd & Fairfax
theorg.com, rocketreach.co	fetches 2026-08-21	David Arnold described as CFO
Growjo	fetches 2026-08-21	\$22.9M revenue; conflicting 85 / 103 headcount

Third-party firmographic enrichment — 2026-08-21, all REPORTED

Verified org record **MVE + Partners, Inc.** / **mve-architects.com** — exact single match, no wrong-company risk. Source of: the detected technology stack (Deltek, Microsoft 365, Revit, Navisworks, BIM 360, SketchUp, Rhino, Adobe InDesign, HubSpot, Salesforce CRM Analytics, OneTrust); the departmental headcount breakdown; growth rates; the modelled \$39.1M revenue figure. **Detection sees web-facing signals only — it cannot see desktop software or an on-premises install.**

KOR's own material — read, not re-derived

docs/bd-dossier-mve-mclarand-2026-06-17.md (2026-06-17) · bd-ca-architect-se-map-2026-06-17.md · bd-ca-sd-synthesis-2026-06-17.md · bd-ca-competitor-matrix-2026-06-17.md · bd-ca-statewide-synthesis-2026-06-18.md · bd-ca-field-guide-2026-06-18.md · audit-2026-08/03-COMPETITIVE-BATTLECARD.md · audit-2026-08/06-DEMO-RUN-SHEET.md · audit-2026-08/07-EXECUTIVE-SUMMARY.md · audit-2026-08/04-TODO-REGISTER.md · audit-2026-08/modules/11-revit-drafter.md · audit-2026-08/modules/12-standards-centralisation.md

What could not be established, restated for the record

Document/PIM stack · Bluebeam and Bluebeam Max · which Deltek product and whether Dela is on · who provides MVE's IT · any published BIM execution plan or CAD standard · any public MVE position on AI · which Revit version · the structural engineer on any Riverwalk phase · the SCoR on OC Vibe · a primary 2026 revenue or headcount figure. Each is a question in \$7, not a guess in \$3.

⚠ **Access limits:** Glassdoor, ZipRecruiter, Indeed and LinkedIn profile pages all returned HTTP 403 or 999 to direct fetch; **CONFIDENTIAL · IAN LALONDE ONLY · DRAFT PENDING REVIEW** multihousingnews.com returned 403. Findings resting on those sources are search-index snippets, tagged **REPORTED**,

and could not be upgraded to **VERIFIED**.